

China consumer

EQUITY: CONSUMER RELATED

CPI moderates in June

Softness of the consumption sector persists

China's CPI remained sluggish in June

On 9 July, China's consumer price index (CPI) posted a 1.0% y-y growth in June (source: National Bureau of Statistics), which slowed further from the 1.2% y-y increase in May and was slightly below the Wind consensus estimate of 1.1% y-y growth. On a month-month basis, CPI contracted by 0.3% in June in comparison to the 0.1% decline in May, indicating persistent softness of the consumption sector. We believe the moderation of CPI inflation in June was mainly due to: 1) shifts in the global geopolitical landscape that resulted in subdued inflation in oil and gold prices; and 2) unfavourable weather conditions that limited consumers' activities. Meanwhile, producer price index (PPI) data was largely on track in June, rising further to 4.1% y-y in June from 3.9% y-y in May, in line with the Wind consensus of a 4.1% y-y increase.

High-level consumption-related policies released

With the overall consumption sentiment being weak, certain high-level consumption-related policies were recently released. Specifically, the Ministry of Commerce and eight other departments jointly issued several opinions on the accelerating innovative development of the retail industry (on 9 July, [link](#)):

- The overall goal: China will establish a modern retail system characterized by rational spatial layout, high-quality supply, diverse formats, intelligent and convenient services, and orderly competition by 2030. The system will include a number of influential retail scenarios, a series of integrated and innovative business models, and a group of internationally competitive retail enterprises.
- Some key measures: the relevant government will: 1) integrate policies in areas such as land use guarantees, financing support, tax and fee reductions, etc., to address urgent and pressing issues affecting the development of the retail industry, promote the concentration of resources and factors of production towards physical retail, tilting policy measures towards physical retail; 2) support qualified new high-quality retail enterprises in their listings on the stock exchanges; and 3) optimize the new competitive environment and address existing concerns around online and offline retail market competition.

Preferred names in our coverage

In light of the overall soft consumption sentiment, we maintain our preference for companies that demonstrate concise development strategies, visible margin trends, and attractive valuations (especially after the recent sector-wide share price weakness).

We continue to prefer ANTA (2020 HK, Buy) in the sportswear sector. The stock currently trades at 14.0x FY26F P/E. We also like Laopu Gold (6181 HK, Buy; trading at 7.7x FY26F P/E) in the retail space, as we believe Laopu has an attractive risk-reward setup now, especially if spot gold prices stabilize in a more accommodative geopolitical environment.

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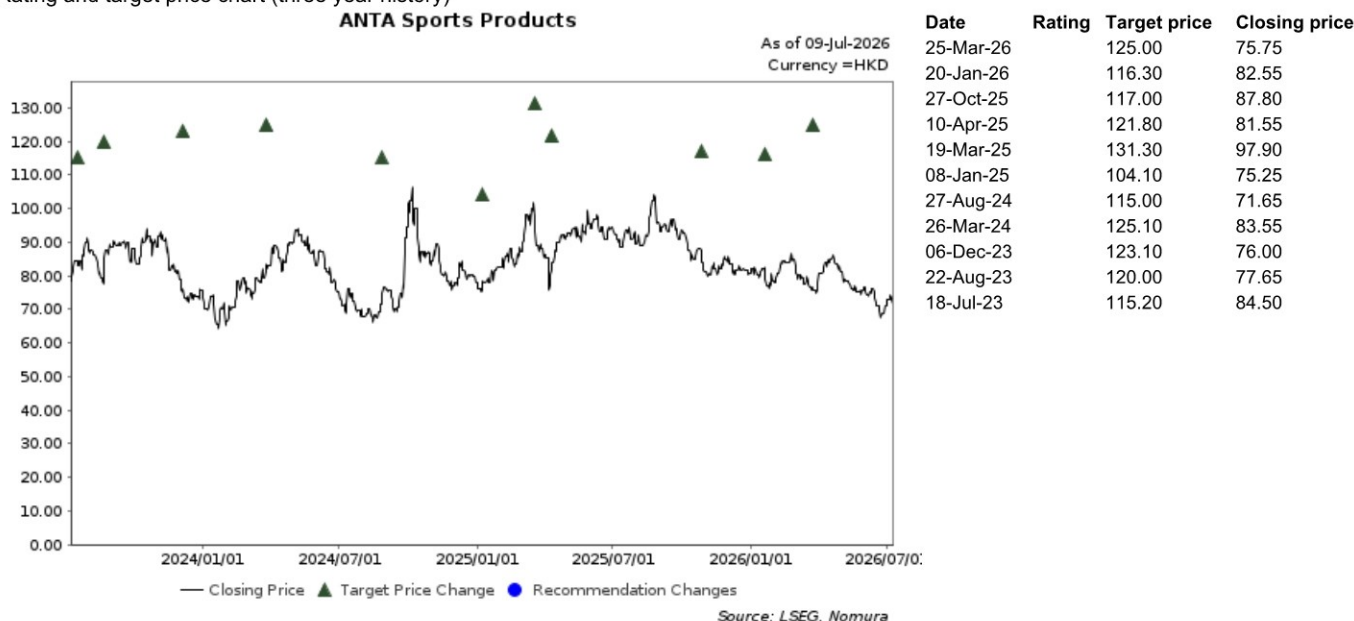
Materially mentioned issuers

Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
ANTA Sports Products	2020 HK	HKD 71.75	09-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	
Laopu Gold	6181 HK	HKD 383.00	09-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	

ANTA Sports Products (2020 HK)

HKD 71.75 (09-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of HKD125 for ANTA is based on 25x F12M P/E, equivalent to its five-year average forward P/E. The benchmark index of ANTA is the Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks to our Buy rating and target price for ANTA include: 1) intensifying competition from both domestic and global players; 2) slower-than-expected sales growth; and 3) weaker-than-expected macroeconomic dynamics.

Laopu Gold (6181 HK)**HKD 383.00 (09-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)**

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of HKD1,114 is based on 22.5x FY26F P/E, consistent with Laopu's high sales and earnings growth trajectory. The benchmark index for the company is the Hang Seng Index.

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As at 30 June 2026.

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